

start the threads, but let them do the running. If you try to execute a `start()` method on a thread that has already been started, the `start()` method throws an

`IllegalThreadStateException`

8.3 static Thread Methods

Many thread methods are static : A static method belongs to the class—not to any one instance of the class. Therefore, you can execute a static method even if you haven't instantiated the class—such as the case of `main`.

8.3.1 static void sleep(long millisecs)

Causes the currently executing thread to sleep (meaning temporarily cease execution) for the specified number of milliseconds.

During this sleep time the thread does not use any resources of the processor.

8.3.2 static Thread currentThread()

Returns a reference to the currently executing thread object.

In other words, if you want to know which thread is currently executing, you execute this method.... and what would be the syntax to do that?

```
Thread x;  
x = Thread.currentThread();
```

8.3.3 static void yield()

Causes the currently executing thread object to temporarily pause and allow other threads of equal priority to execute.

You would use the method `yield()` only if your operating system did not support preemptive multithreading.

8.3.4 static boolean interrupted()

True or False. Tests whether or not the current thread has been interrupted recently.

This static method discovers whether or not the current thread has been interrupted. Calling this method also resets the “interrupted” status of its argument. This particular method can be easily confused with another method similarly named. The emphasis here is on `CURRENT THREAD`. For this method, we don't get to choose the thread we wish to test. By default, it tests whether or not the current thread is interrupted.